



Grade 3 FAST ELA Reading

Spring 2024 Released Test Items

from **Flight**

by Robert Burleigh

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- 1.** Read this paragraph from the passage.

56 He quickly unfolds a map across his knees.

What does the prefix *un-* in the word unfolds show about Lindbergh's actions?

- Ⓐ that he opens the map
- Ⓑ that he holds tightly to the map
- Ⓒ that he finds where he is on the map
- Ⓓ that he makes enough room for the map

2. Read these paragraphs from the passage.

47 He spies a seagull.

48 Then fishing boats. Something quickens in Lindbergh's blood.

Why does the author include these paragraphs in the passage?

- Ⓐ to describe what is making Lindbergh sick
- Ⓑ to explain how Lindbergh is feeling as he nears land
- Ⓒ to give an example of the different ways to get to Paris
- Ⓓ to compare traveling to Paris with other kinds of activities

3. What specific idea does the title help suggest?

- Ⓐ The passage will be about what pilots do before a flight.
- Ⓑ The passage will be about how flights have changed over time.
- Ⓒ The passage will be about what a pilot experiences on a certain flight.
- Ⓓ The passage will be about how flights have prepared people for other types of travel.

4. What is the overall text structure in the passage?

- Ⓐ chronology
- Ⓑ comparison
- Ⓒ cause and effect
- Ⓓ problem and solution

- 5.** This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which claim does the author support about Lindbergh?

- Ⓐ He fits best in small planes.
- Ⓑ He begins to feel lonely on his flight.
- Ⓒ He wants people to give him a nickname.
- Ⓓ He needs more time to prepare for his flight.

Part B

Which detail from the passage supports the claim in Part A?

- Ⓐ “Lindbergh is nearly as tall as the plane itself.” (paragraph 8)
- Ⓑ “And yet—he is about to attempt what no one has done before:” (paragraph 9)
- Ⓒ “The day comes on, brighter and warmer.” (paragraph 41)
- Ⓓ “He hopes for a word. He longs for a wave,” (paragraph 51)

6. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which sentence is a central idea of the passage?

- Ⓐ Pilots receive support from people.
- Ⓑ Lindbergh has doubts about flying.
- Ⓒ Lindbergh makes his dream come true.
- Ⓓ Airplanes have greatly improved since the first flights.

Part B

Which moment from the passage supports the central idea in Part A?

- Ⓐ "He clicks on the engine. He listens as it catches, gurgles, and roars." (paragraph 15)
- Ⓑ "Sometimes he imagines he sees land. No: it is only the flickering shapes of the clouds." (paragraphs 42–43)
- Ⓒ "He guides the *Spirit of St. Louis* carefully down and down, to just above a boat." (paragraph 49)
- Ⓓ "*I am here, I am here.* A great joy wells up inside him." (paragraphs 70–71)

7. What does the word huddled mean as it is used in paragraph 73?

- Ⓐ curled up
- Ⓑ tried moving
- Ⓒ traveled safely
- Ⓓ crowded together

8. Select **two** details that should be included in a summary of the passage.

- Ⓐ Charles Lindbergh flies over the coast of Ireland.
- Ⓑ Charles Lindbergh starts his flight while it is raining.
- Ⓒ Charles Lindbergh flies an airplane from New York to Paris.
- Ⓓ Charles Lindbergh can see cows and boats from his airplane.
- Ⓔ Charles Lindbergh plans to fly for more than a day without stopping.

Passage 1: A Yummy Invention

by Tracy Vonder Brink

- 1 Oops! Frank Epperson forgot to bring his cup inside. He'd made a fruity drink by mixing a flavored powder and water together, but he left it on the porch overnight. The cup had his drink and the mixing stick still inside it.
- 2 The night was freezing cold. The next morning, Frank went outside and saw his cup. His drink had frozen. He pulled on the mixing stick. The frozen drink came out of the cup. It looked like a big, fruity icicle on a stick. Would it taste good? He licked the flavored ice. Yum!
- 3 Frank never forgot the icy treat he'd invented back in 1905, when he was 11 years old. When he grew up and had kids of his own, he made ice pops for them. Then he wondered . . . could he sell his dessert?
- 4 Frank took his ice pops to an amusement park. Everyone loved what he'd made! At first, he called his invention the Epsicle, because his last name was Epperson. But his kids didn't like the sound of that. They called their dad "Pop," so they came up with a different name, the Popsicle.
- 5 Popsicles were a hit! Frank made new flavors. People loved those too. Then a big company bought Frank's recipe. They made more and more Popsicles.
- 6 Today you can buy Popsicles on one stick or on two. They come in many fruit flavors and even in chocolate.

"A Yummy Invention" by Tracy Vonder Brink. Copyright © 2019 by Click Magazine. Reprinted by permission of Cricket Media, Inc., via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: Who Invented the Ice Cream Cone?

by Laurel Plausini

7 People all across America enjoy ice cream cones. They are an excellent way to enjoy a scoop or two of your favorite ice cream on a hot day.

8 But who invented this delicious treat?

9 No one knows for sure. Ice cream shops in Italy are said to have sold something similar to cones as far back as 1807. An ice cream maker in New York City is said to have made an edible cup for ice cream in 1903.

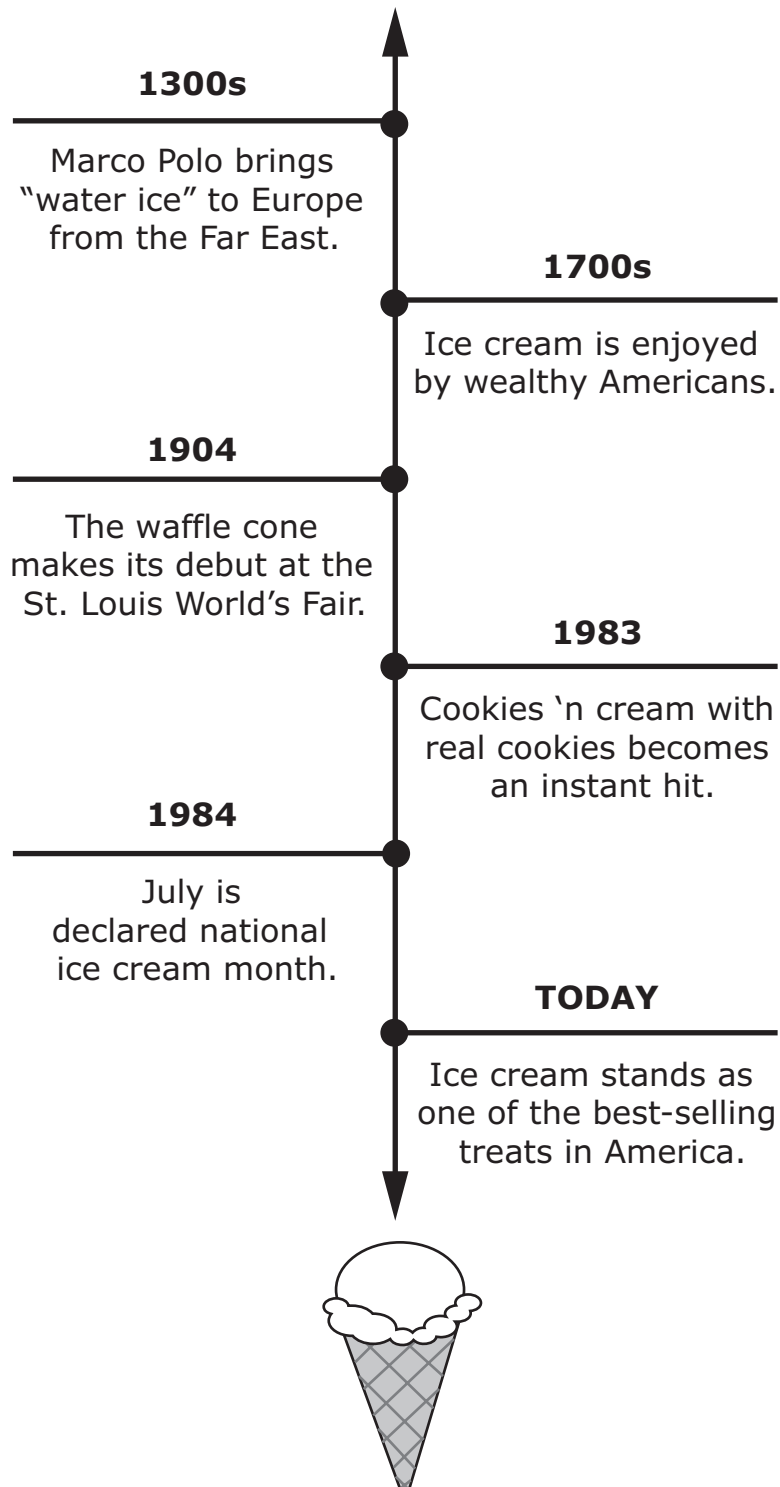
10 But the most popular story about the invention of the cone came a year later. The city of St. Louis was hosting a World's Fair in 1904. A vendor was selling scoops of his delicious ice cream at the fair. His ice cream was so popular on that day that he ran out of dishes to serve people. He was in a sticky situation.

11 Ernest Hamwi was selling crispy waffles at the booth next door. He saw the pickle his fellow businessman was in. He quickly thought of a solution. He took one of his waffles and rolled it up into the shape of a cone. He gave it to the vendor after it cooled off. The vendor put ice cream inside the cone and sold it to customers. Everyone soon wanted a taste of this new invention. Many believe this is the event that made the ice cream cone popular.

12 Hamwi's quick thinking resulted in great success. He soon started his own company called Cornocopia Waffle Oven Company. He promoted his cones to fairs all across America. They were a big hit.

13 No matter how the cone came to be, this happy invention has brought joy to millions of people.

History of Ice Cream



"Who Invented the Ice Cream Cone?" by Laurel Plausini. Written for educational purposes. "History of Ice Cream" graphic created for educational purposes.

9. Read the sentence from Passage 1.

“Popsicles were a hit!” (paragraph 5)

What is the meaning of the phrase were a hit as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ kept cold
- Ⓑ needed work
- Ⓒ tasted sweet
- Ⓓ became popular

10. Read the sentence from Passage 1.

“But his kids didn’t like the sound of that.” (paragraph 4)

Why did the author include this detail in the passage?

- Ⓐ to explain how the Popsicle was named
- Ⓑ to show how Frank Epperson invented the Popsicle
- Ⓒ to tell why so many flavors of Popsicles were made
- Ⓓ to describe why Frank Epperson sold Popsicles to a big company

11. Select **two** sentences that belong in a summary of Passage 1.

- Ⓐ Popsicles are usually sold at amusement parks.
- Ⓑ Popsicles look similar to icicles in the wintertime.
- Ⓒ Frank got the name for his treat from his children.
- Ⓓ Frank sold his invention to many small companies.
- Ⓔ Frank forgot his drink outside on a cold night as a boy.

12. In Passage 1, how does the author support the claim that people really like Popsicles?

- Ⓐ by showing how Popsicles are made
- Ⓑ by explaining where Popsicles are sold
- Ⓒ by stating that Popsicles are still made today
- Ⓓ by telling about different types of sticks from Popsicles

13. In Passage 1, which sentence supports the central idea that inventions can come from mistakes?

- Ⓐ "The night was freezing cold." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "It looked like a big, fruity icicle on a stick." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Frank made new flavors." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ "Today you can buy Popsicles on one stick or on two." (paragraph 6)

14. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

“He promoted his cones to fairs all across America.” (paragraph 12)

What is the meaning of promoted as it is used in the sentence?

- Ⓐ sold eagerly
- Ⓑ invented quickly
- Ⓒ returned carefully
- Ⓓ packaged differently

15. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

“He saw the pickle his fellow businessman was in.” (paragraph 11)

Why does the author use the phrase “the pickle” in this sentence?

- Ⓐ to describe the purpose of the cones
- Ⓑ to show that it was hard to sell waffles
- Ⓒ to describe the types of food sold at the fair
- Ⓓ to show that the ice cream vendor had a problem

16. In Passage 2, how does the timeline support information from the passage?

- Ⓐ It explains where waffle cones are sold.
- Ⓑ It shows who the first person to eat ice cream was.
- Ⓒ It explains how different flavors were added to ice cream.
- Ⓓ It shows how waffle cones fit into the creation of ice cream.

17. In Passage 2, why does the author include the story about Ernest Hamwi?

- Ⓐ to help explain the history of ice cream cones
- Ⓑ to show the reader that he was a busy vendor
- Ⓒ to describe the different types of waffles he made
- Ⓓ to persuade the reader that cones are better than dishes

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18. Fill in the bubbles to show whether each sentence describes the topic of Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
A child invents something delicious.	☐ A	☐ B	☐ C
A person is successful because of an invention.	☐ D	☐ E	☐ F
A problem leads to a new invention.	☐ G	☐ H	☐ I

When Seven DeSwapp Hopped

by Bronchelle Parker

- 1 Seven DeSwapp was so excited when she woke up early Saturday morning. She was going to the beach.
- 2 Every summer, the DeSwapps took a special family trip to the beach. And every summer, Seven's big brother, Ras, found the best treasures there. Last year, he saw dolphins diving into the ocean.
- 3 "**Eureka**," he would cry when he found a treasure.
- 4 Seven called him Ras the Terrific Treasure Finder. This year, she wanted to be a Terrific Treasure Finder, too.
- 5 "Eureka." She practiced on her way downstairs with Ras. The night before, she had made a list of all the treasures she wanted to find at the beach. A sandcastle with a moat. A starfish. And a cute baby crab.
- 6 But when Seven and Ras got to the living room, Ms. DeSwapp did *not* look ready for the beach. She was wearing sneakers. *Not* sandals. And she had on a big backpack. *Not* a bathing suit. Seven and Ras scratched their heads, trading puzzled looks.
- 7 "Surprise," sang Ms. DeSwapp. She tossed each of them a sleeping bag. "This year, we're kicking it up a notch. Bye-bye, beach. We're going camping in the mountains."
- 8 "Sweet." Ras jumped up and down, his dreadlocks dancing about his head.
- 9 Seven's heart sank.
- 10 "Are there sandcastles in the mountains, Mama?" she asked.
- 11 "No, silly," giggled Ras. . . .
- 12 It was a long drive to the mountains. Seven looked out the window. At first, the land looked as flat as the pancakes she ate for breakfast. Then the ground slowly started to rise into giant hills with pointy tops.
- 13 Seven closed her eyes and tried to imagine what kind of treasures she would find in the mountains. But all she could think of were sandcastles, starfish, and cute baby crabs. . . .
- 14 Ms. DeSwapp stopped at a perfect spot in the woods to camp. Then up, up went their tent. And up, up went their feet as they set out for a big hike.
- 15 Seven hiked very carefully, so she wouldn't miss any treasures.
- 16 "Eureka." She practiced while she searched for treasures over big rocks . . . and under little rocks, too. She searched between the bushy bushes . . . and around the tall, tall trees.

- 17 When they reached a tiny stream, Seven took a break from treasure hunting.
- 18 “Whew!” she huffed, squatting to sit on a rock.
- 19 But just as she did, the rock began to croak like a frog! “Ribbit,” croaked the rock. “Ribbit-ribbit.”
- 20 Suddenly, six green frogs hopped out from behind the rock.
- 21 “Ribbit,” they croaked, happily hopping high.
- 22 Soon, Seven joined in the frogs’ fun. “Ribbit,” she croaked, hopping up and down. “Ribbit-ribbit.”
- 23 Before long, the DeSwapps were playing a silly game of leapfrog. Seven hopped over Ras. Then she hopped over Ms. DeSwapp. She even hopped over the tiny stream.
- 24 Bright yellow butterflies greeted Seven on the other side of the stream. Their soft wings tickled her cheeks as they swirled around her head. Then off they flew towards a loud *SHHHH* coming from the distance.
- 25 It sounded like rain. *SHHHH*.
- 26 Slowly, Seven followed the sound. She crept down the trail on her tiptoes.
- 27 Closer and closer she came, until she was standing across from a beautiful waterfall. It looked like buckets of water falling from a big cliff with a *SHHHH* and landing, drop after drop, in a pool.
- 28 It was the most terrific treasure Seven had ever seen.
- 29 Just behind her, Ras and Ms. DeSwapp watched the waterfall in wide-eyed amazement.
- 30 “Sweet find, Seven,” squealed Ras.
- 31 Bursting with excitement, Seven threw her arms in the air. And in a voice loud enough to shake the mountains, she cried, “Eureka!”

Glossary

eureka: a cry of joy when someone finds or discovers something

Excerpt from “When Seven DeSwapp Hopped” by Bronchelle Parker, from *Ladybug* Magazine.
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19. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Then off they flew towards a loud *SHHHH* coming from the distance.”
(paragraph 24)

The word distance comes from the Latin root word meaning “standing apart.” Based on this information, what does distance mean as it is used in the sentence?

- Ⓐ a place that is far away
- Ⓑ a place that is full of wildlife
- Ⓒ a place that is unusually large
- Ⓓ a place that is good for gathering

20. Read this sentence from the passage.

9 Seven's heart sank.

What does this sentence show about Seven?

- Ⓐ She feels afraid of the mountains.
- Ⓑ She feels disappointed by the surprise.
- Ⓒ She feels bored by the idea of camping.
- Ⓓ She feels tired from making a list for the trip.

21. How does Ras feel about the trip to the mountains?

- Ⓐ He is ready to become the best at a new skill.
- Ⓑ He is happy to go on a different type of adventure.
- Ⓒ He is glad that he prepared for many different events.
- Ⓓ He is hoping to see some of the same treasures again.

- 22.** How does the author develop the theme that something special can happen when you are not expecting it?
- Ⓐ by telling why Seven’s family decides to go on a trip
 - Ⓑ by describing why Seven enjoys the car ride to the mountains
 - Ⓒ by showing how Seven’s family finds a good place for camping
 - Ⓓ by explaining how Seven discovers the waterfall during a game

23. Read this sentence from the passage.

“It looked like buckets of water falling from a big cliff with a *SHHHH* and landing, drop after drop, in a pool.” (paragraph 27)

Why does the author describe the waterfall this way?

- Ⓐ to explain how much water is moving
- Ⓑ to show how the water is held at the top
- Ⓒ to explain what it feels like to be in the water
- Ⓓ to show that there are surprises hiding in the water

24. Read this paragraph from the passage.

28 It was the most terrific treasure Seven had ever seen.

How does this paragraph show a change in Seven's character?

- Ⓐ She knows that working as a team can be helpful.
- Ⓑ She feels that past trips have actually been boring.
- Ⓒ She understands that visiting a different place was a good idea.
- Ⓓ She sees that people have their own opinions of what is special.

- 25.** Complete the table to show whether each detail describes the perspective of Seven, Ms. DeSwapp, or both characters.

	Seven	Ms. DeSwapp	Both Characters
wants to work toward a certain goal	(A)	(B)	(C)
knows that a trip can lead to exciting moments	(D)	(E)	(F)
enjoys planning new things for the family to do	(G)	(H)	(I)

- 26.** Which sentence from the passage supports the theme that it can be good to stay hopeful when plans change?
- Ⓐ “And every summer, Seven’s big brother, Ras, found the best treasures there.” (paragraph 2)
 - Ⓑ “But when Seven and Ras got to the living room, Ms. DeSwapp did *not* look ready for the beach.” (paragraph 6)
 - Ⓒ “But all she could think of were sandcastles, starfish, and cute baby crabs.” (paragraph 13)
 - Ⓓ “She practiced while she searched for treasures over big rocks . . . and under little rocks, too.” (paragraph 16)

Passage 1: Punky Dunk and the Mouse

by Anonymous

- 1 Punky Dunk, very sly, with a wink of his eye
Strolled lazily all through the house;
To the cellar he went and the morning he spent
On a hunt for a fat little mouse.
- 5 “Over there by the coal,” he said, “Mouse has his hole,
So I’ll sit there beside it and wait.
There’s a trap with some cheese just as nice as you please,
And Mouse soon will come out for that bait.”

- Punky sat by the trap, and seemed taking a nap,
10 But you know that bold Punky was wise.
Though he looked half asleep he was taking a peep
For the gleam of two bright little eyes.

- Soon the mouse crept right out and went running about;
Punky smiled to himself and he said:
15 “I will just let him play in his own foolish way
Till I think that I need to be fed.”

- But the Mouse, too, was smart, and he got a good start,
Then he leaped, and he saved his wee hide,
For he dashed in a hole that was not near the coal
20 But was hidden away at one side.

“Ha, Ha!” Punky said as he shook his white head.
“Well, Mouse, you may run if you please,
But I’ll eat just the same—’twas for that that I came.”
So he reached in the trap for the cheese.

- 25 Snip-snap! went the trap—Wasn’t that a mishap!
Punky’s black little paw was inside.
He leaped and he jumped and he ran and he bumped—
And the Mouse sat and laughed till he cried.

- Punky ran up the stairs and he knocked over chairs
30 And he sprang to the table and dropped,
He “Meowed!” in his fright, for the trap held him tight,
And it was a long time till he stopped.

- Baby's mama then came and she said: "What a shame!"
And she took off the trap from his paw,
35 And she wrapped it in silk and she fed him with milk
And she gave him some fish bones to gnaw.

"Punky Dunk and the Mouse" by Anonymous. In the public domain.

Passage 2: The Little Thief in the Pantry

by Anonymous

- 1 "MOTHER dear," said a little mouse one day, "I think the people in
our house must be very kind; don't you?" . . .
- 2 There was a twinkle in the mother's eye as she replied,—
- 3 "Well, my child, no doubt they are very well in their way, but
I don't think they are quite as fond of us as you seem to think. Now
remember, Greywhiskers, I have absolutely forbidden you to put your
nose above the ground unless I am with you, for kind as the people
are, I shouldn't be at all surprised if they tried to catch you."
- 4 Greywhiskers twitched his tail with scorn; he was quite sure he
knew how to take care of himself, and he didn't mean to trot meekly
after his mother's tail all his life. So as soon as she had curled herself
up for an afternoon nap he stole away, and scampered across the
pantry shelves.
- 5 . . . A large iced cake stood far back upon the shelf, and
Greywhiskers licked his lips as he sniffed it. Across the top of the cake
there were words written in pink sugar; . . . he did not know that he
was nibbling at little Miss Ethel's birthday cake. But he did feel a little
guilty when he heard his mother calling. Off he ran, and was back in
the nest again by the time his mother had finished rubbing her eyes
after her nap. . . .
- 6 The next day the naughty little mouse again popped up to the
pantry when his mother was asleep; but at first he could find
nothing at all to eat, though there was a most delicious smell of
toasted cheese.
- 7 Presently he found a dear little wooden house, and there hung
the cheese, just inside it.
- 8 In ran Greywhiskers, but, oh! "click" went the little wooden house,
and mousie was caught fast in a trap.

- 9 When the morning came, the cook, who had set the trap, lifted it from the shelf, and then called a pretty little girl to come and see the thief who had eaten her cake. . . .
- 10 “You didn’t know it was stealing, did you, mousie dear?” [the little girl] said.
- 11 “No,” squeaked Greywhiskers sadly; “indeed I didn’t.”
- 12 Cook’s back was turned for a moment, and in that moment tender-hearted little Ethel lifted the lid of the trap, and out popped mousie.
- 13 Oh! how quickly he ran home to his mother . . . and then she made him promise never to disobey her again, and you may be sure he never did.

Excerpt from “The Little Thief in the Pantry” by Anonymous. In the public domain.

27. What type of poem is Passage 1?

- Ⓐ haiku
- Ⓑ limerick
- Ⓒ free verse
- Ⓓ rhymed verse

28. Select **two** lines from Passage 1 that show how Punky Dunk changes throughout the poem.

- Ⓐ "Strolled lazily all through the house;" (line 2)
- Ⓑ "To the cellar he went and the morning he spent" (line 3)
- Ⓒ "'I will just let him play in his own foolish way'" (line 15)
- Ⓓ "'Well, Mouse, you may run if you please,'" (line 22)
- Ⓔ "Punky ran up the stairs and he knocked over chairs" (line 29)

29. How does Passage 1 support the theme of outsmarting others?

- Ⓐ by explaining why Punky Dunk seems so bold
- Ⓑ by showing that the mouse was scared of Punky Dunk
- Ⓒ by explaining how Punky Dunk came up with a successful plan
- Ⓓ by describing how the mouse gets away from Punky Dunk in the end

30. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the Mouse's view of Punky Dunk in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ He is not afraid of Punky Dunk.
- Ⓑ He is curious about Punky Dunk.
- Ⓒ He is confused by what Punky Dunk does.
- Ⓓ He is not happy about what happens to Punky Dunk.

Part B

Which line from Passage 1 supports the answer in Part A?

- Ⓐ "Snip-snap! went the trap—Wasn't that a mishap!" (line 25)
- Ⓑ "Punky's black little paw was inside." (line 26)
- Ⓒ "He leaped and he jumped and he ran and he bumped—" (line 27)
- Ⓓ "And the Mouse sat and laughed till he cried." (line 28)

31. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“Oh! how quickly he ran home to his mother . . . and then she made him promise never to disobey her again, and you may be sure he never did.”
(paragraph 13)

What is the meaning of disobey as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ to get help with a task
- Ⓑ to not do what you are told
- Ⓒ to do something without thinking
- Ⓓ to think about what could happen

32. Which **two** events in Passage 2 show that Greywhiskers changes in the passage?

- Ⓐ He forgets to save some of Ethel's birthday cake for his mother.
- Ⓑ He enjoys the company of humans who live in the house with him.
- Ⓒ He feels sorry when Ethel releases him and he returns to his mother.
- Ⓓ He acts sneaky and goes into the pantry without his mother's permission.
- Ⓔ He gives up searching for food once he cannot find any cheese that he likes.

33. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“Greywhiskers twitched his tail with scorn; he was quite sure he knew how to take care of himself, and he didn’t mean to trot meekly after his mother’s tail all his life.” (paragraph 4)

What does this sentence show about how Greywhiskers feels?

- Ⓐ He wants to please his mother.
- Ⓑ He wants to move to a new house.
- Ⓒ He wants to make his own decisions.
- Ⓓ He wants to make others afraid of him.

- 34.** Fill in the bubbles to show the different viewpoints of the characters in Passage 2.

	Greywhiskers	Mother	Ethel
enjoys exploring alone	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
thinks it is important to help those in need	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
is careful about living with others in the house	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓖ

35. Select **two** details that belong in a summary of Passage 2.

- Ⓐ Greywhiskers regrets not listening to his mother.
- Ⓑ Greywhiskers enjoys the smell of toasted cheese.
- Ⓒ Greywhiskers sees pink icing on Ethel's birthday cake.
- Ⓓ Greywhiskers becomes trapped when looking for food.
- Ⓔ Greywhiskers's mother rubs her eyes after taking a nap.

36. Fill in the bubbles to show which lesson the main character learns in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
Following rules is important.	☐ A	☐ B	☐ C
Attempting to harm others can lead to hurting oneself.	☐ D	☐ E	☐ F
Be certain about a plan before it is carried out.	☐ G	☐ H	☐ I

37. How is Greywhiskers's experience in Passage 2 similar to Punky Dunk's experience in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Both are given food in the end.
- Ⓑ Both are comforted by their mothers.
- Ⓒ Both are shown pity after they are caught.
- Ⓓ Both are able to get out of a trap on their own.



Grade 3 FAST ELA Reading

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from Flight

by Robert Burleigh

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1. Read this paragraph from the passage.

56 He quickly unfolds a map across his knees.

What does the prefix *un-* in the word unfolds show about Lindbergh's actions?

- Ⓐ that he opens the map
- Ⓑ that he holds tightly to the map
- Ⓒ that he finds where he is on the map
- Ⓓ that he makes enough room for the map

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

2. Read these paragraphs from the passage.

47 He spies a seagull.

48 Then fishing boats. Something quickens in Lindbergh's blood.

Why does the author include these paragraphs in the passage?

- Ⓐ to describe what is making Lindbergh sick
- Ⓑ to explain how Lindbergh is feeling as he nears land
- Ⓒ to give an example of the different ways to get to Paris
- Ⓓ to compare traveling to Paris with other kinds of activities

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the development of an author's purpose in an informational text.

3. What specific idea does the title help suggest?

- Ⓐ The passage will be about what pilots do before a flight.
- Ⓑ The passage will be about how flights have changed over time.
- Ⓒ The passage will be about what a pilot experiences on a certain flight.
- Ⓓ The passage will be about how flights have prepared people for other types of travel.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to meaning and identify the text structures of chronology, comparison, and cause/effect in texts.

4. What is the overall text structure in the passage?

- Ⓐ chronology
- Ⓑ comparison
- Ⓒ cause and effect
- Ⓓ problem and solution

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to meaning and identify the text structures of chronology, comparison, and cause/effect in texts.

5. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which claim does the author support about Lindbergh?

- Ⓐ He fits best in small planes.
- Ⓑ He begins to feel lonely on his flight.
- Ⓒ He wants people to give him a nickname.
- Ⓓ He needs more time to prepare for his flight.

Part B

Which detail from the passage supports the claim in Part A?

- Ⓐ “Lindbergh is nearly as tall as the plane itself.” (paragraph 8)
- Ⓑ “And yet—he is about to attempt what no one has done before:” (paragraph 9)
- Ⓒ “The day comes on, brighter and warmer.” (paragraph 41)
- Ⓓ “He hopes for a word. He longs for a wave,” (paragraph 51)

Answer Key: Part A: B and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 23%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Identify an author’s claim and explain how an author uses evidence to support the claim.

6. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which sentence is a central idea of the passage?

- Ⓐ Pilots receive support from people.
- Ⓑ Lindbergh has doubts about flying.
- Ⓒ Lindbergh makes his dream come true.
- Ⓓ Airplanes have greatly improved since the first flights.

Part B

Which moment from the passage supports the central idea in Part A?

- Ⓐ "He clicks on the engine. He listens as it catches, gurgles, and roars." (paragraph 15)
- Ⓑ "Sometimes he imagines he sees land. No: it is only the flickering shapes of the clouds." (paragraphs 42–43)
- Ⓒ "He guides the *Spirit of St. Louis* carefully down and down, to just above a boat." (paragraph 49)
- Ⓓ "I am here, I am here. A great joy wells up inside him." (paragraphs 70–71)

Answer Key: Part A: C and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Identify the central idea and explain how relevant details support that idea in a text.

7. What does the word huddled mean as it is used in paragraph 73?

- Ⓐ curled up
- Ⓑ tried moving
- Ⓒ traveled safely
- Ⓓ crowded together

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

8. Select **two** details that should be included in a summary of the passage.

- Ⓐ Charles Lindbergh flies over the coast of Ireland.
- Ⓑ Charles Lindbergh starts his flight while it is raining.
- Ⓒ Charles Lindbergh flies an airplane from New York to Paris.
- Ⓓ Charles Lindbergh can see cows and boats from his airplane.
- Ⓔ Charles Lindbergh plans to fly for more than a day without stopping.

Answer Key: C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.2b

Benchmark Description: Include the central idea and relevant details for an informational text.

Passage 1: A Yummy Invention

by Tracy Vonder Brink

- 1 Oops! Frank Epperson forgot to bring his cup inside. He'd made a fruity drink by mixing a flavored powder and water together, but he left it on the porch overnight. The cup had his drink and the mixing stick still inside it.
- 2 The night was freezing cold. The next morning, Frank went outside and saw his cup. His drink had frozen. He pulled on the mixing stick. The frozen drink came out of the cup. It looked like a big, fruity icicle on a stick. Would it taste good? He licked the flavored ice. Yum!
- 3 Frank never forgot the icy treat he'd invented back in 1905, when he was 11 years old. When he grew up and had kids of his own, he made ice pops for them. Then he wondered . . . could he sell his dessert?
- 4 Frank took his ice pops to an amusement park. Everyone loved what he'd made! At first, he called his invention the Epsicle, because his last name was Epperson. But his kids didn't like the sound of that. They called their dad "Pop," so they came up with a different name, the Popsicle.
- 5 Popsicles were a hit! Frank made new flavors. People loved those too. Then a big company bought Frank's recipe. They made more and more Popsicles.
- 6 Today you can buy Popsicles on one stick or on two. They come in many fruit flavors and even in chocolate.

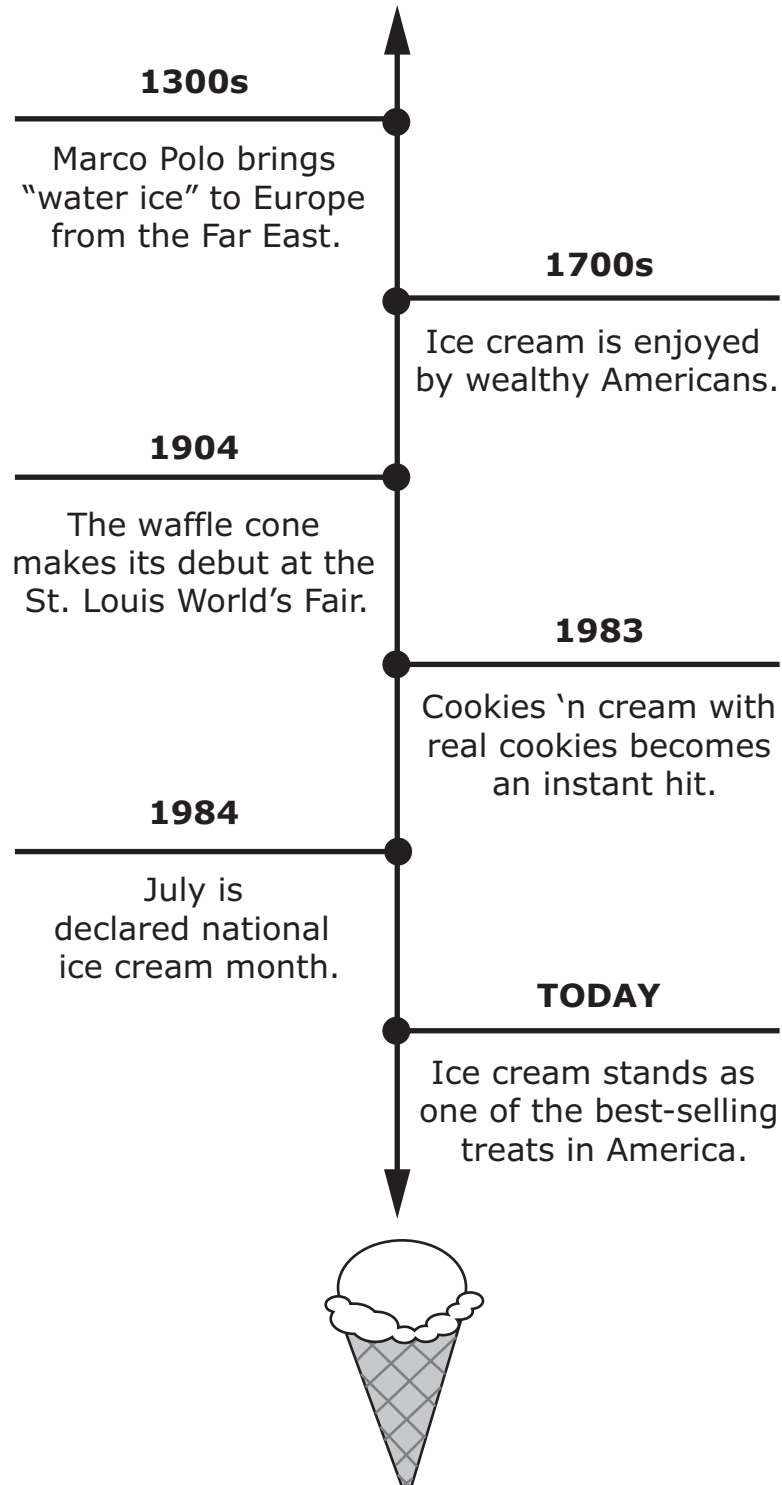
"A Yummy Invention" by Tracy Vonder Brink. Copyright © 2019 by Click Magazine. Reprinted by permission of Cricket Media, Inc., via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: Who Invented the Ice Cream Cone?

by Laurel Plausini

- 7 People all across America enjoy ice cream cones. They are an excellent way to enjoy a scoop or two of your favorite ice cream on a hot day.
- 8 But who invented this delicious treat?
- 9 No one knows for sure. Ice cream shops in Italy are said to have sold something similar to cones as far back as 1807. An ice cream maker in New York City is said to have made an edible cup for ice cream in 1903.
- 10 But the most popular story about the invention of the cone came a year later. The city of St. Louis was hosting a World's Fair in 1904. A vendor was selling scoops of his delicious ice cream at the fair. His ice cream was so popular on that day that he ran out of dishes to serve people. He was in a sticky situation.
- 11 Ernest Hamwi was selling crispy waffles at the booth next door. He saw the pickle his fellow businessman was in. He quickly thought of a solution. He took one of his waffles and rolled it up into the shape of a cone. He gave it to the vendor after it cooled off. The vendor put ice cream inside the cone and sold it to customers. Everyone soon wanted a taste of this new invention. Many believe this is the event that made the ice cream cone popular.
- 12 Hamwi's quick thinking resulted in great success. He soon started his own company called Cornocopia Waffle Oven Company. He promoted his cones to fairs all across America. They were a big hit.
- 13 No matter how the cone came to be, this happy invention has brought joy to millions of people.

History of Ice Cream



"Who Invented the Ice Cream Cone?" by Laurel Plausini. Written for educational purposes. "History of Ice Cream" graphic created for educational purposes.

9. Read the sentence from Passage 1.

“Popsicles were a hit!” (paragraph 5)

What is the meaning of the phrase were a hit as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ kept cold
- Ⓑ needed work
- Ⓒ tasted sweet
- Ⓓ became popular

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

10. Read the sentence from Passage 1.

“But his kids didn’t like the sound of that.” (paragraph 4)

Why did the author include this detail in the passage?

- ☒ Ⓐ to explain how the Popsicle was named
- ☐ Ⓑ to show how Frank Epperson invented the Popsicle
- ☐ Ⓒ to tell why so many flavors of Popsicles were made
- ☐ Ⓓ to describe why Frank Epperson sold Popsicles to a big company

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 69%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the development of an author’s purpose in an informational text.

11. Select **two** sentences that belong in a summary of Passage 1.

- Ⓐ Popsicles are usually sold at amusement parks.
- Ⓑ Popsicles look similar to icicles in the wintertime.
- Ⓒ Frank got the name for his treat from his children.
- Ⓓ Frank sold his invention to many small companies.
- Ⓔ Frank forgot his drink outside on a cold night as a boy.

Answer Key: C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 28%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.2b

Benchmark Description: Include the central idea and relevant details for an informational text.

12. In Passage 1, how does the author support the claim that people really like Popsicles?

- Ⓐ by showing how Popsicles are made
- Ⓑ by explaining where Popsicles are sold
- Ⓒ by stating that Popsicles are still made today
- Ⓓ by telling about different types of sticks from Popsicles

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Identify an author's claim and explain how an author uses evidence to support the claim.

13. In Passage 1, which sentence supports the central idea that inventions can come from mistakes?

- Ⓐ "The night was freezing cold." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "It looked like a big, fruity icicle on a stick." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Frank made new flavors." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ "Today you can buy Popsicles on one stick or on two." (paragraph 6)

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Identify the central idea and explain how relevant details support that idea in a text.

14. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

“He promoted his cones to fairs all across America.” (paragraph 12)

What is the meaning of promoted as it is used in the sentence?

- Ⓐ sold eagerly
- Ⓑ invented quickly
- Ⓒ returned carefully
- Ⓓ packaged differently

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

15. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

“He saw the pickle his fellow businessman was in.” (paragraph 11)

Why does the author use the phrase “the pickle” in this sentence?

- Ⓐ to describe the purpose of the cones
- Ⓑ to show that it was hard to sell waffles
- Ⓒ to describe the types of food sold at the fair
- Ⓓ to show that the ice cream vendor had a problem

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and explain metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in text(s).

16. In Passage 2, how does the timeline support information from the passage?

- Ⓐ It explains where waffle cones are sold.
- Ⓑ It shows who the first person to eat ice cream was.
- Ⓒ It explains how different flavors were added to ice cream.
- Ⓓ It shows how waffle cones fit into the creation of ice cream.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to meaning and identify the text structures of chronology, comparison, and cause/effect in texts.

17. In Passage 2, why does the author include the story about Ernest Hamwi?

- ☒ Ⓐ to help explain the history of ice cream cones
- ☐ Ⓑ to show the reader that he was a busy vendor
- ☐ Ⓒ to describe the different types of waffles he made
- ☐ Ⓓ to persuade the reader that cones are better than dishes

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the development of an author's purpose in an informational text.

- 18.** Fill in the bubbles to show whether each sentence describes the topic of Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
A child invents something delicious.	☒ A	☐ B	☐ C
A person is successful because of an invention.	☐ D	☐ E	☒ F
A problem leads to a new invention.	☐ G	☒ H	☐ I

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how two authors present information on the same topic or theme.

When Seven DeSwapp Hopped

by Bronchelle Parker

- 1 Seven DeSwapp was so excited when she woke up early Saturday morning. She was going to the beach.
- 2 Every summer, the DeSwapps took a special family trip to the beach. And every summer, Seven's big brother, Ras, found the best treasures there. Last year, he saw dolphins diving into the ocean.
- 3 "**Eureka**," he would cry when he found a treasure.
- 4 Seven called him Ras the Terrific Treasure Finder. This year, she wanted to be a Terrific Treasure Finder, too.
- 5 "Eureka." She practiced on her way downstairs with Ras. The night before, she had made a list of all the treasures she wanted to find at the beach. A sandcastle with a moat. A starfish. And a cute baby crab.
- 6 But when Seven and Ras got to the living room, Ms. DeSwapp did *not* look ready for the beach. She was wearing sneakers. *Not* sandals. And she had on a big backpack. *Not* a bathing suit. Seven and Ras scratched their heads, trading puzzled looks.
- 7 "Surprise," sang Ms. DeSwapp. She tossed each of them a sleeping bag. "This year, we're kicking it up a notch. Bye-bye, beach. We're going camping in the mountains."
- 8 "Sweet." Ras jumped up and down, his dreadlocks dancing about his head.
- 9 Seven's heart sank.
- 10 "Are there sandcastles in the mountains, Mama?" she asked.
- 11 "No, silly," giggled Ras. . . .
- 12 It was a long drive to the mountains. Seven looked out the window. At first, the land looked as flat as the pancakes she ate for breakfast. Then the ground slowly started to rise into giant hills with pointy tops.
- 13 Seven closed her eyes and tried to imagine what kind of treasures she would find in the mountains. But all she could think of were sandcastles, starfish, and cute baby crabs. . . .
- 14 Ms. DeSwapp stopped at a perfect spot in the woods to camp. Then up, up went their tent. And up, up went their feet as they set out for a big hike.
- 15 Seven hiked very carefully, so she wouldn't miss any treasures.
- 16 "Eureka." She practiced while she searched for treasures over big rocks . . . and under little rocks, too. She searched between the bushy bushes . . . and around the tall, tall trees.

- 17 When they reached a tiny stream, Seven took a break from treasure hunting.
- 18 “Whew!” she huffed, squatting to sit on a rock.
- 19 But just as she did, the rock began to croak like a frog! “Ribbit,” croaked the rock. “Ribbit-ribbit.”
- 20 Suddenly, six green frogs hopped out from behind the rock.
- 21 “Ribbit,” they croaked, happily hopping high.
- 22 Soon, Seven joined in the frogs’ fun. “Ribbit,” she croaked, hopping up and down. “Ribbit-ribbit.”
- 23 Before long, the DeSwapps were playing a silly game of leapfrog. Seven hopped over Ras. Then she hopped over Ms. DeSwapp. She even hopped over the tiny stream.
- 24 Bright yellow butterflies greeted Seven on the other side of the stream. Their soft wings tickled her cheeks as they swirled around her head. Then off they flew towards a loud *SHHHH* coming from the distance.
- 25 It sounded like rain. *SHHHH*.
- 26 Slowly, Seven followed the sound. She crept down the trail on her tiptoes.
- 27 Closer and closer she came, until she was standing across from a beautiful waterfall. It looked like buckets of water falling from a big cliff with a *SHHHH* and landing, drop after drop, in a pool.
- 28 It was the most terrific treasure Seven had ever seen.
- 29 Just behind her, Ras and Ms. DeSwapp watched the waterfall in wide-eyed amazement.
- 30 “Sweet find, Seven,” squealed Ras.
- 31 Bursting with excitement, Seven threw her arms in the air. And in a voice loud enough to shake the mountains, she cried, “Eureka!”

Glossary

eureka: a cry of joy when someone finds or discovers something

Excerpt from “When Seven DeSwapp Hopped” by Bronchelle Parker, from *Ladybug* Magazine.
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19. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Then off they flew towards a loud *SHHHH* coming from the distance.”
(paragraph 24)

The word distance comes from the Latin root word meaning “standing apart.” Based on this information, what does distance mean as it is used in the sentence?

- ☒ Ⓐ a place that is far away
- ☐ Ⓑ a place that is full of wildlife
- ☐ Ⓒ a place that is unusually large
- ☐ Ⓓ a place that is good for gathering

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 77%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

20. Read this sentence from the passage.

9 Seven’s heart sank.

What does this sentence show about Seven?

- Ⓐ She feels afraid of the mountains.
- Ⓑ She feels disappointed by the surprise.
- Ⓒ She feels bored by the idea of camping.
- Ⓓ She feels tired from making a list for the trip.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and explain metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in text(s).

21. How does Ras feel about the trip to the mountains?

- Ⓐ He is ready to become the best at a new skill.
- Ⓑ He is happy to go on a different type of adventure.
- Ⓒ He is glad that he prepared for many different events.
- Ⓓ He is hoping to see some of the same treasures again.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters' perspectives in a literary text.

22. How does the author develop the theme that something special can happen when you are not expecting it?

- Ⓐ by telling why Seven’s family decides to go on a trip
- Ⓑ by describing why Seven enjoys the car ride to the mountains
- Ⓒ by showing how Seven’s family finds a good place for camping
- Ⓓ by explaining how Seven discovers the waterfall during a game

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

23. Read this sentence from the passage.

“It looked like buckets of water falling from a big cliff with a *SHHHH* and landing, drop after drop, in a pool.” (paragraph 27)

Why does the author describe the waterfall this way?

- ☒ Ⓐ to explain how much water is moving
- ☐ Ⓑ to show how the water is held at the top
- ☐ Ⓒ to explain what it feels like to be in the water
- ☐ Ⓓ to show that there are surprises hiding in the water

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and explain metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in text(s).

24. Read this paragraph from the passage.

28 It was the most terrific treasure Seven had ever seen.

How does this paragraph show a change in Seven's character?

- Ⓐ She knows that working as a team can be helpful.
- Ⓑ She feels that past trips have actually been boring.
- Ⓒ She understands that visiting a different place was a good idea.
- Ⓓ She sees that people have their own opinions of what is special.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

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25. Complete the table to show whether each detail describes the perspective of Seven, Ms. DeSwapp, or both characters.

	Seven	Ms. DeSwapp	Both Characters
wants to work toward a certain goal	☒ A	☐ B	☐ C
knows that a trip can lead to exciting moments	☐ D	☐ E	☒ F
enjoys planning new things for the family to do	☐ G	☒ H	☐ I

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters’ perspectives in a literary text.

26. Which sentence from the passage supports the theme that it can be good to stay hopeful when plans change?

- Ⓐ “And every summer, Seven’s big brother, Ras, found the best treasures there.” (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ “But when Seven and Ras got to the living room, Ms. DeSwapp did *not* look ready for the beach.” (paragraph 6)
- Ⓒ “But all she could think of were sandcastles, starfish, and cute baby crabs.” (paragraph 13)
- Ⓓ “She practiced while she searched for treasures over big rocks . . . and under little rocks, too.” (paragraph 16)

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

Passage 1: Punky Dunk and the Mouse

by Anonymous

- 1 Punky Dunk, very sly, with a wink of his eye
Strolled lazily all through the house;
To the cellar he went and the morning he spent
On a hunt for a fat little mouse.
- 5 “Over there by the coal,” he said, “Mouse has his hole,
So I’ll sit there beside it and wait.
There’s a trap with some cheese just as nice as you please,
And Mouse soon will come out for that bait.”

- Punky sat by the trap, and seemed taking a nap,
10 But you know that bold Punky was wise.
Though he looked half asleep he was taking a peep
For the gleam of two bright little eyes.

- Soon the mouse crept right out and went running about;
Punky smiled to himself and he said:
15 “I will just let him play in his own foolish way
Till I think that I need to be fed.”

- But the Mouse, too, was smart, and he got a good start,
Then he leaped, and he saved his wee hide,
For he dashed in a hole that was not near the coal
20 But was hidden away at one side.

- “Ha, Ha!” Punky said as he shook his white head.
“Well, Mouse, you may run if you please,
But I’ll eat just the same—’twas for that that I came.”
So he reached in the trap for the cheese.
- 25 Snip-snap! went the trap—Wasn’t that a mishap!
Punky’s black little paw was inside.
He leaped and he jumped and he ran and he bumped—
And the Mouse sat and laughed till he cried.

- Punky ran up the stairs and he knocked over chairs
30 And he sprang to the table and dropped,
He “Meowed!” in his fright, for the trap held him tight,
And it was a long time till he stopped.

- Baby's mama then came and she said: "What a shame!"
 And she took off the trap from his paw,
 35 And she wrapped it in silk and she fed him with milk
 And she gave him some fish bones to gnaw.

"Punky Dunk and the Mouse" by Anonymous. In the public domain.

Passage 2: The Little Thief in the Pantry

by Anonymous

- 1 "MOTHER dear," said a little mouse one day, "I think the people in
 our house must be very kind; don't you?" . . .
- 2 There was a twinkle in the mother's eye as she replied,—
- 3 "Well, my child, no doubt they are very well in their way, but
 I don't think they are quite as fond of us as you seem to think. Now
 remember, Greywhiskers, I have absolutely forbidden you to put your
 nose above the ground unless I am with you, for kind as the people
 are, I shouldn't be at all surprised if they tried to catch you."
- 4 Greywhiskers twitched his tail with scorn; he was quite sure he
 knew how to take care of himself, and he didn't mean to trot meekly
 after his mother's tail all his life. So as soon as she had curled herself
 up for an afternoon nap he stole away, and scampered across the
 pantry shelves.
- 5 . . . A large iced cake stood far back upon the shelf, and
 Greywhiskers licked his lips as he sniffed it. Across the top of the cake
 there were words written in pink sugar; . . . he did not know that he
 was nibbling at little Miss Ethel's birthday cake. But he did feel a little
 guilty when he heard his mother calling. Off he ran, and was back in
 the nest again by the time his mother had finished rubbing her eyes
 after her nap. . . .
- 6 The next day the naughty little mouse again popped up to the
 pantry when his mother was asleep; but at first he could find
 nothing at all to eat, though there was a most delicious smell of
 toasted cheese.
- 7 Presently he found a dear little wooden house, and there hung
 the cheese, just inside it.
- 8 In ran Greywhiskers, but, oh! "click" went the little wooden house,
 and mousie was caught fast in a trap.

- 9 When the morning came, the cook, who had set the trap, lifted it from the shelf, and then called a pretty little girl to come and see the thief who had eaten her cake. . . .
- 10 “You didn’t know it was stealing, did you, mousie dear?” [the little girl] said.
- 11 “No,” squeaked Greywhiskers sadly; “indeed I didn’t.”
- 12 Cook’s back was turned for a moment, and in that moment tender-hearted little Ethel lifted the lid of the trap, and out popped mousie.
- 13 Oh! how quickly he ran home to his mother . . . and then she made him promise never to disobey her again, and you may be sure he never did.

Excerpt from “The Little Thief in the Pantry” by Anonymous. In the public domain.

27. What type of poem is Passage 1?

- Ⓐ haiku
- Ⓑ limerick
- Ⓒ free verse
- Ⓓ rhymed verse

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Identify types of poems: free verse, rhymed verse, haiku, and limerick.

28. Select **two** lines from Passage 1 that show how Punky Dunk changes throughout the poem.

- Ⓐ "Strolled lazily all through the house;" (line 2)
- Ⓑ "To the cellar he went and the morning he spent" (line 3)
- Ⓒ "'I will just let him play in his own foolish way'" (line 15)
- Ⓓ "'Well, Mouse, you may run if you please,'" (line 22)
- Ⓔ "Punky ran up the stairs and he knocked over chairs" (line 29)

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 25%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

29. How does Passage 1 support the theme of outsmarting others?

- Ⓐ by explaining why Punky Dunk seems so bold
- Ⓑ by showing that the mouse was scared of Punky Dunk
- Ⓒ by explaining how Punky Dunk came up with a successful plan
- Ⓓ by describing how the mouse gets away from Punky Dunk in the end

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

30. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the Mouse's view of Punky Dunk in Passage 1?

- ☒ Ⓐ He is not afraid of Punky Dunk.
- ☐ Ⓑ He is curious about Punky Dunk.
- ☐ Ⓒ He is confused by what Punky Dunk does.
- ☐ Ⓓ He is not happy about what happens to Punky Dunk.

Part B

Which line from Passage 1 supports the answer in Part A?

- ☐ Ⓐ "Snip-snap! went the trap—Wasn't that a mishap!" (line 25)
- ☐ Ⓑ "Punky's black little paw was inside." (line 26)
- ☐ Ⓒ "He leaped and he jumped and he ran and he bumped—" (line 27)
- ☒ Ⓓ "And the Mouse sat and laughed till he cried." (line 28)

Answer Key: Part A: A and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters' perspectives in a literary text.

31. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“Oh! how quickly he ran home to his mother . . . and then she made him promise never to disobey her again, and you may be sure he never did.”
(paragraph 13)

What is the meaning of disobey as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ to get help with a task
- Ⓑ to not do what you are told
- Ⓒ to do something without thinking
- Ⓓ to think about what could happen

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

32. Which **two** events in Passage 2 show that Greywhiskers changes in the passage?

- Ⓐ He forgets to save some of Ethel’s birthday cake for his mother.
- Ⓑ He enjoys the company of humans who live in the house with him.
- Ⓒ He feels sorry when Ethel releases him and he returns to his mother.
- Ⓓ He acts sneaky and goes into the pantry without his mother’s permission.
- Ⓔ He gives up searching for food once he cannot find any cheese that he likes.

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

33. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“Greywhiskers twitched his tail with scorn; he was quite sure he knew how to take care of himself, and he didn’t mean to trot meekly after his mother’s tail all his life.” (paragraph 4)

What does this sentence show about how Greywhiskers feels?

- Ⓐ He wants to please his mother.
- Ⓑ He wants to move to a new house.
- Ⓒ He wants to make his own decisions.
- Ⓓ He wants to make others afraid of him.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

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34. Fill in the bubbles to show the different viewpoints of the characters in Passage 2.

	Greywhiskers	Mother	Ethel
enjoys exploring alone	☒ (A)	☐ (B)	☐ (C)
thinks it is important to help those in need	☐ (D)	☐ (E)	☒ (F)
is careful about living with others in the house	☐ (G)	☒ (H)	☐ (I)

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters' perspectives in a literary text.

35. Select **two** details that belong in a summary of Passage 2.

- ☒ (A) Greywhiskers regrets not listening to his mother.
- ☐ (B) Greywhiskers enjoys the smell of toasted cheese.
- ☐ (C) Greywhiskers sees pink icing on Ethel’s birthday cake.
- ☒ (D) Greywhiskers becomes trapped when looking for food.
- ☐ (E) Greywhiskers’s mother rubs her eyes after taking a nap.

Answer Key: A, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.2a

Benchmark Description: Include plot and theme for a literary text.

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36. Fill in the bubbles to show which lesson the main character learns in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
Following rules is important.	☐ A	☒ B	☐ C
Attempting to harm others can lead to hurting oneself.	☒ D	☐ E	☐ F
Be certain about a plan before it is carried out.	☐ G	☐ H	☒ I

Answer Key: B, D, I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how two authors present information on the same topic or theme.

37. How is Greywhiskers's experience in Passage 2 similar to Punky Dunk's experience in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Both are given food in the end.
- Ⓑ Both are comforted by their mothers.
- Ⓒ Both are shown pity after they are caught.
- Ⓓ Both are able to get out of a trap on their own.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 39%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how two authors present information on the same topic or theme.